sooner than anyone had expected, but we responded well as a team, and David Miller and JP proceeded to rescue the innings.

Dave scored 138 not out and JP made 115 not out as we reached 339 for four in our 50 overs. Zimbabwe fought hard and, in reply, reached 191 for two after 32 overs before we finally managed to apply some pressure, bowled them out for 277 and nailed down a tough victory by 62 runs.

We travelled to Melbourne for our next game, against India, and everyone seemed in good spirits. I was starting to enjoy the responsibility of captaincy and relishing the challenge of leading this group of young men through a World Cup, which, I desperately hoped, would unfold as the highlight in all our careers.

The squad gathered, as usual, at six o'clock on the evening before the match and, after Russell had spoken, I made a couple of points, firstly suggesting everyone should keep their eyes on the ball at all times because that was a good way to stay focused when playing in front of a big crowd in a big stadium; and, secondly, urging everyone to adapt to the flow of the game, recognising when we had the momentum and needed to push on, and also seeing when the game was running against us and being able to pull back a touch and control the damage.

I finished by reading a quotation from a film I had watched with David Miller. *Lone Survivor* was a dramatisation of an actual raid to capture a Taliban leader in Afghanistan by four United States Navy SEALs, in which Marcus Luttrell, played by Mark Wahlberg, was the only one to survive.

The quote was: 'Brave men fought and died building a proud tradition and fear of reputation that I am bound to uphold. I died up on that mountain. There is no question that a part of me will forever be up on that mountain, dead, as my brothers died. There is a part of me that lived because of my brothers. Because of them I am still alive, and I can never forget that no matter how much it hurts, how dark it gets or how far you fall, you are never out of the fight.'

That was my message: it was going to be tough and there would be